



DEEPIKA PADUKONE
37, ACTOR & ENTREPRENEUR

Leading Lady

IF SHAH RUKH Khan set the cash registers ringing in 2023 with blockbusters like *Pathaan* and *Jawan* at a time when Bollywood desperately needed a pick-me-up to boost its collections, he had excellent company in both those movies in

Deepika Padukone. But apart from being one of the most bankable names in the Hindi film industry, Padukone has also evolved into a multifaceted brand. Top-grossing film projects as an actor and producer aside, she has also carved a niche for

WHY SHE MATTERS

With many blockbusters and a number of global brand endorsements to her name, she has evolved into a role model for many, even as she remains one of the most bankable names in Hindi cinema

herself as an investor, entrepreneur, global brand ambassador and mental health champion.

One of the most well-known Indian faces internationally, representing luxury brands such as Louis Vuitton and Cartier, 2023 has seen her become the global brand ambassador for Qatar Airways as well. With well-known brands such as Adidas, Levi's, and Pottery Barn already in her kitty, Padukone is among the Top 5 most valued celebrities in India. Her brand valuation was pegged at a whopping \$82.9 million in 2022 by financial advisory firm Kroll.

The universe of her ventures has also expanded over the years. There's DPKA Universal Consumer Ventures, under which she launched her premium skincare range 82°E in November 2022. Her family office KA Enterprises has invested in firms such as Epigamia, Furlenco, BluSmart, Atomberg, and Moko-bara, among others. Then, there's KA Productions—that has bankrolled films such as *Chhapaak* and '83, while her non-profit organisation, The Live Love Laugh Foundation—that she set up after her own battle with depression—works towards improving mental health awareness.

With the multi-starrer *Project K* and *Fighter* coming up on the work front, there's no stopping this leading lady, on or off the screen. **BT**

— BY VIDYA S.



GHAZAL ALAGH
35, CO-FOUNDER AND CHIEF INNOVATION OFFICER, MAMAEARTH

PATH TO GROWTH

For Ghazal Alagh, one thing she has learnt from her entrepreneurial journey is that one won't know everything on Day One. "You just need to start and figure things out along the way," says Alagh, the force behind Honasa Consumer—the parent of direct-to-consumer (D2C) brand Mamaearth—that got listed in November. Under her, Honasa posted a 58.3 per cent year-on-year surge in revenues, at ₹1,493 crore in FY23. According to brokerage firm Emkay Global, Alagh's 'house of brands' portfolio, that includes Mamaearth, The Derma Co, and BBLunt, sets the stage for sustained growth. With her strategic vision and commitment to sustainable practices, Mamaearth is well-positioned as a frontrunner in the D2C space. **BT**

— BY PRERNA LIDHOO